

Design & Frontend Direction — AI Grant Assistant for NGOs

Product Vision

A modern AI-powered platform that helps nonprofit organizations discover grants, manage applications, and generate funding proposals faster through intelligent workflows and automation.

The interface should feel:

- modern
- lightweight
- intelligent
- trustworthy
- productivity-focused
- professional but human

The experience should combine:

- Kanban workflow management
 - AI copilots
 - nonprofit/funding dashboards
 - document editing
 - clean SaaS UX
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Frontend Stack

Core Framework

- Next.js
 - React
 - TypeScript
-

Styling

Recommended

- Tailwind CSS

Why:

- fast development
 - modern SaaS styling
 - easy responsive design
 - hackathon-friendly
-

UI Components

Recommended

- shadcn/ui

Why:

- modern aesthetic
 - accessibility-focused
 - highly customizable
 - clean enterprise feel
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Drag and Drop

Recommended

- dnd-kit

Used for:

- Kanban board
 - moving grants between stages
 - interactive workflows
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Charts & Metrics

Recommended

- Recharts

Used for:

- funding analytics
 - grant progress
 - organization insights
-

Animations

Recommended

- Framer Motion

Used subtly for:

- modal transitions
- AI loading states
- panel animations
- drag interactions

Animations should feel:

- smooth
 - minimal
 - premium
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AI Interaction Design

The AI should feel:

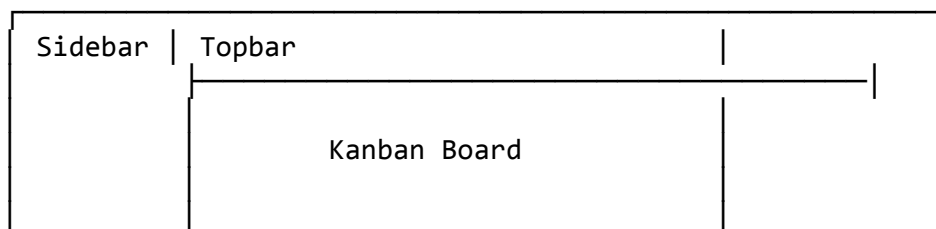
- contextual
- collaborative
- assistive
- intelligent

Not:

- chatbot-centric
- gimmicky

The AI should appear integrated into workflows.

Main Layout Structure



Sidebar Navigation

Sections:

- Dashboard
- Grant Opportunities
- Applications
- Proposal Drafts
- AI Assistant
- Organization Profile
- Settings

Style:

- minimal icons
 - subtle hover effects
 - compact spacing
 - collapsible
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Kanban Board Style

Inspired by:

- Trello
- Linear
- Monday.com

Columns:

- Opportunities Found
- Reviewing
- Drafting Proposal
- Submitted

Cards should contain:

- Grant title
- Match score

- Deadline
 - Funding amount
 - Tags/categories
-

Match Score Visualization

Important visual element.

Examples:

- 92% Match
- High Compatibility

Style:

- colored progress indicators
 - clean badges
 - soft gradients
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Proposal Editor UX

Inspired by:

- Notion
- Google Docs AI

Features:

- inline editing
 - AI rewrite buttons
 - tone adjustment
 - expand/shorten actions
 - impact suggestions
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Visual Style

Overall Design Philosophy

- clean SaaS
- productivity-oriented
- high readability

- minimal clutter
 - whitespace-heavy
 - soft shadows
 - rounded corners
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Recommended Color Palettes

Palette 1 — Professional Modern

Primary:

- #2563EB (Blue)

Accent:

- #10B981 (Emerald)

Background:

- #F8FAFC

Text:

- #0F172A
-

Palette 2 — AI Startup Feel

Primary:

- #7C3AED (Purple)

Accent:

- #06B6D4 (Cyan)

Background:

- #F5F3FF

Text:

- #111827
-

Palette 3 — Nonprofit / Human-Centered

Primary:

- #059669 (Green)

Accent:

- #0EA5E9 (Sky Blue)

Background:

- #F9FAFB

Text:

- #1F2937
-

Dark Mode

Strongly recommended.

Inspired by:

- Linear
- Notion
- Vercel

Characteristics:

- dark gray backgrounds
- subtle borders
- soft contrast
- minimal saturation

Avoid:

- pure black
 - neon overload
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UI Inspiration Sources

Strongest Inspirations

- Linear
 - Notion
 - Airtable
 - Monday.com
-

Additional Inspiration Platforms

UI Galleries

- SaaS Interface
 - Mobbin
 - Dribbble
 - Land-book
-

Important UX Details

AI Loading States

Instead of: “Loading...”

Use:

- “Analyzing grant requirements...”
- “Generating proposal structure...”
- “Calculating organization compatibility...”

This creates:

- perceived intelligence
 - product immersion
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Typography

Recommended Fonts

- Inter
 - Geist
 - Plus Jakarta Sans
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Responsiveness

Priority:

- desktop first

But:

- tablet support important
 - mobile optional for MVP
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MVP UI Priorities

Focus on:

- polished Kanban
- beautiful proposal editor
- strong AI interactions
- smooth UX

Do NOT overbuild:

- settings
 - notifications
 - enterprise features
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Final Design Goal

The product should feel like: “A modern AI productivity platform for nonprofits”

Not: “A hackathon prototype with AI glued on top.”